

# The Record of Jesus Christ

## Pure evidentiary claim index

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Claims: 162 · Tiers: {"verified":54,"well\_attested":62,"contested":23,"interpretive":12,"speculative":2,"literary\_theological":3,"circumstantial":10}

Every claim is labeled by evidence tier. Proof-grade data is never conflated with literary or theological development. This PDF is a portable index; the live platform at [veritasworldwide.com/record-of-jesus-christ](https://veritasworldwide.com/record-of-jesus-christ) remains the canonical interactive surface.

## Methodology (summary)

Tiers: Verified · Well-Attested · Circumstantial · Contested · Interpretive · Speculative · Literary/Theological. Tools: multiple attestation, Nestle-Aland/UBS standards, archaeological dating with ranges, observational cosmology as science only.

[verified] ane-babylonian-chronicles

**Babylonian Chronicles document Nebuchadnezzar’s campaigns against Jerusalem, providing independent chronological control for the late Iron Age Judah narrative.**

[verified] ane-black-obelisk

**The Black Obelisk of Shalmaneser III depicts Jehu (or a representative) of Israel paying tribute — an extra-biblical visual control for the Omride/Jehu period.**

[well\_attested] ane-cos-corpus

**The Context of Scripture (COS) and ANET anthologies assemble primary ANE texts used as comparative controls for Hebrew Bible literature and historiography.**

[verified] ane-cyrus-cylinder

**The Cyrus Cylinder (c. 539 BCE) records Achaemenid policy of restoring temples and returning displaced populations after the conquest of Babylon.**

[contested] ane-exodus-historicity

**The historicity and scale of an Israelite exodus from Egypt remain contested in critical scholarship.**

[well\_attested] ane-flood-literature

**Mesopotamian flood traditions (Atrahasis, Gilgamesh XI) are independent literary parallels to Genesis flood narrative forms.**

[well\_attested] ane-hezekiah-lmlk

**lmlk jar handles and related Judahite administrative seals concentrate in late eighth-century contexts associated with Hezekiah’s reign and Assyrian threat.**

[well\_attested] ane-inscription-map

**Key West Semitic and Egyptian inscriptions relevant to Israel/Judah (Merneptah, Mesha, Tel Dan, Siloam, etc.) form a geographically distributed control set across Egypt, Transjordan, and the Galilee–Golan.**

[verified] ane-lachish-letters

**The Lachish ostraca (letters) are late-Iron-Age Hebrew administrative/military correspondence relevant to Judah’s final decades before the Babylonian destruction.**

[verified] ane-merneptah

**The Merneptah Stele (c. 1208 BCE) contains the earliest known extra-biblical reference to “Israel” as a people in Canaan.**

[verified] ane-mesha

**The Mesha Stele (c. 840 BCE) names Omri of Israel, Yahweh, and Moabite campaigns paralleling 2 Kings 3.**

[verified] ane-sennacherib

**Sennacherib's annals (Taylor Prism / related prisms) describe the 701 BCE campaign against Judah and Hezekiah's tribute without claiming Jerusalem's capture.**

[verified] ane-tel-dan

**The Tel Dan Stele (9th century BCE) attests the phrase "House of David" (bytdwd) outside the Bible.**

[well\_attested] ane-ugarit

**Ugaritic texts (Ras Shamra) supply Northwest Semitic mythic and ritual parallels used in comparative study of Hebrew Bible poetry and divine council language.**

[verified] arch-bar-kokhba

**The Bar Kokhba revolt (132–135 CE) is archaeologically and papyrologically attested; its aftermath reshaped Judean demography and Jewish–Christian trajectories.**

[contested] arch-bethsaida

**Bethsaida identification and Early Roman occupation layers are active archaeological research topics relevant to Galilee Gospel geography.**

[verified] arch-caesarea-maritima

**Caesarea Maritima — Herodian harbor city and later Roman provincial capital — is extensively excavated and contextualizes prefectural administration relevant to Pilate traditions.**

[well\_attested] arch-capernaum

**Capernaum (Kfar Nahum) was a fishing village on the Sea of Galilee with Early Roman occupation; a later synagogue stands over earlier remains.**

[verified] arch-destruction-70

**The Roman destruction of Jerusalem and the Temple in 70 CE is multiply attested (Josephus; archaeological burn/destruction layers; Roman triumph iconography such as the Arch of Titus spoils relief).**

[verified] arch-galilee-boat

**The "Jesus Boat" (first-century Galilee boat, discovered 1986) illustrates fishing technology on the lake in the Early Roman period.**

[contested] arch-james-ossuary

**The so-called James ossuary inscription ("James son of Joseph brother of Jesus") remains contested regarding authenticity of the brother phrase and provenance.**

[contested] arch-jericho

**Jericho's Late Bronze destruction layers and relation to a conquest narrative remain a classic contested case in biblical archaeology.**

[well\_attested] arch-magdala

**Magdala excavations reveal a first-century Galilean town with a synagogue and harbor installations, enriching the social map of Jesus' activity zone.**

[well\_attested] arch-masada

**Masada's archaeology confirms a First Jewish Revolt–period fortress with Roman siege works; Josephus's mass-suicide narrative is only partly controllable by material remains.**

[well\_attested] arch-nazareth

**Nazareth existed as a small Jewish settlement in the Early Roman period; monumental first-century remains are limited.**

[verified] arch-ossuaries-practice

**Secondary burial in limestone ossuaries is archaeologically well attested in late Second Temple Jerusalem and environs (roughly late 1st c. BCE–70 CE).**

[well\_attested] arch-pool-bethesda

**Excavations north of the Temple Mount have exposed twin pools matching John’s description of Bethesda with five porticoes (John 5) better than once assumed.**

[interpretive] arch-quran-not-control

**The Qur’an (7th c. CE) is a late secondary witness for first-century Palestinian history and is not used here as a primary control for the historical Jesus.**

[verified] arch-sepphoris

**Sepphoris (Zippori), ~6 km from Nazareth, was a significant urban center in Early Roman Galilee under Antipas.**

[verified] arch-siloam

**The Siloam Tunnel inscription (discovered 1880) describes construction of Hezekiah’s tunnel, matching 2 Kings 20:20 / 2 Chr 32:30 as royal hydraulic works.**

[speculative] arch-talpiot

**Talpiot “Jesus family tomb” statistical and onomastic claims are speculative and rejected by most specialists as identification of the New Testament Jesus.**

[well\_attested] arch-titus

**1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.**

[verified] arch-yehohanan

**The crucified remains of Yehohanan son of Hagkol (Giv’at ha-Mivtar) provide osteological evidence of Roman crucifixion practice in Judea (nail through heel bone).**

[well\_attested] cosmo-age

**Under Planck 2018  $\Lambda$ CDM parameters, the universe age is approximately 13.8 billion years.**

[verified] cosmo-bao

**Baryon acoustic oscillations (BAO) measured in large-scale galaxy surveys provide an independent standard-ruler constraint on the expansion history within  $\Lambda$ CDM.**

[well\_attested] cosmo-bbn

**Primordial abundances of light elements (tHe, D,  $^3\text{He}$ , wLi) are broadly consistent with Big Bang nucleosynthesis predictions.**

[verified] cosmo-cmb

**The cosmic microwave background (CMB) is a near-isotropic blackbody at  $T \approx 2.725$  K.**

[verified] cosmo-cmb-power

**The CMB angular power spectrum exhibits acoustic peaks whose positions and amplitudes constrain baryon density, dark matter density, and curvature in  $\Lambda$ CDM fits.**

[verified] cosmo-dark-energy

**Type Ia supernova surveys (1990s–present) established late-time accelerated expansion consistent with cosmological-constant / dark-energy component.**

[verified] cosmo-expansion

**Spectroscopic redshift of galaxies correlates with distance (Hubble–Lemaître law), indicating metric expansion of space.**

[interpretive] cosmo-fine-tuning-params

**Several dimensionless physical parameters appear finely constrained for complex chemistry; teleological interpretation is philosophical, not a scientific conclusion of this Record.**

[contested] cosmo-hubble-tension

**The Hubble tension denotes a statistically significant discrepancy between early-universe (CMB-inferred) and some late-universe local H<sub>0</sub> measurements.**

[well\_attested] cosmo-matter-energy

**Planck baseline  $\Lambda$ CDM reports cold dark matter and dark energy as dominant densities of the universe.**

[contested] cosmo-nucleosynthesis-li

**The cosmological lithium problem remains an open tension between standard BBN predictions and stellar abundance measurements.**

[verified] cosmo-recombination

**CMB photons free-stream from the surface of last scattering at recombination ( $z \approx 1100$ ).**

[well\_attested] ec-1clement

**1 Clement (usually dated late 1st c.) attests early Roman Christian leadership correspondence and cites Jesus traditions and Pauline letters as authoritative.**

[verified] ec-apostolic-fathers

**The Apostolic Fathers (1 Clement, Didache, Ignatius, Polycarp, etc.) provide early non-NT Christian primary sources.**

[verified] ec-athanasius

**Athanasius, 39th Festal Letter (367 CE), lists the exact 27-book New Testament canon later ratified in the West.**

[well\_attested] ec-didache

**The Didache preserves an early Christian “two ways” ethic, baptismal and eucharistic instructions, and itinerant ministry rules — dating commonly late 1st / early 2nd c.**

[well\_attested] ec-eusebius-he

**Eusebius’s Ecclesiastical History (early 4th c.) is a foundational but tendentious narrative source for earlier Christian writers, martyrdoms, and canon discussions.**

[well\_attested] ec-gospel-harmony

**Tatian’s Diatessaron (late 2nd c.) harmonized the four Gospels into a single narrative widely used in Syriac Christianity — evidence of early fourfold Gospel prestige and of textual fluidity in use.**

[contested] ec-gospel-thomas

**The Gospel of Thomas (Nag Hammadi) is a sayings gospel whose dating and dependence on canonical Gospels are contested.**

[well\_attested] ec-ignatius

**Ignatius of Antioch’s letters (early 2nd c., authenticity of middle recension majority) show moniscopacy advocacy and high Christological language in transit to martyrdom.**

[verified] ec-irenaeus

**Irenaeus (c. 180 CE) argues for a fourfold Gospel (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John) against alternative gospel usages.**

[well\_attested] ec-justin-apology

**Justin Martyr’s First Apology (mid-2nd c.) describes Christian worship, “memoirs of the apostles,” and defends Christians before a Roman audience.**

[well\_attested] ec-marcion

**Marcion of Sinope (mid-2nd century) promulgated a reduced Gospel+Paul collection, prompting proto-orthodox canon and theological responses.**

[well\_attested] ec-muratorian

**The Muratorian Fragment is an early (often 2nd-century, date contested) Latin canon list showing a nearly formed but not identical NT collection.**

[literary\_theological] ec-nicaea

**The Council of Nicaea (325 CE) addressed Christological doctrine (homoousios) under Constantine; it did not create the NT canon list.**

[well\_attested] ec-origen-hexapla

**Origen's Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek OT columns for comparative textual work — early Christian engagement with pluriform scriptural text.**

[interpretive] ec-update-triggers

**This Record's perpetual update triggers include: new major papyri/majuscule publications, INTF Liste changes, peer-reviewed dig reports, and material consensus shifts in historical Jesus research.**

[contested] hj-apocalyptic

**Whether Jesus is best reconstructed as primarily apocalyptic prophet (Schweitzer trajectory) or sapiential/ethical teacher remains a major scholarly divide.**

[well\_attested] hj-appearances

**Early Christian proclamation included claims of post-crucifixion appearances to individuals and groups (1 Cor 15:3–8); the nature of those experiences is not scientifically settled.**

[well\_attested] hj-baptism

**Baptism of Jesus by John the Baptist is widely judged historical under the criterion of embarrassment and multiple attestation.**

[contested] hj-bethlehem

**Bethlehem birth is narrated in Matthew and Luke with divergent infancy stories; historical verification is contested, while Nazareth association is stronger.**

[well\_attested] hj-caiaphas

**An ossuary inscribed “Yehosef bar Qayafa” (discovered 1990) is widely identified with the high-priestly family of Caiaphas.**

[interpretive] hj-criteria-limits

**Classical authenticity criteria (multiple attestation, embarrassment, dissimilarity) are heuristic tools with known biases; they do not yield laboratory-grade “proof” of individual sayings.**

[interpretive] hj-criterion-coherence

**Coherence criteria ask whether a proposed saying/deed fits a reconstructed core portrait of Jesus; the method is circular if the core is itself unstable.**

[verified] hj-crucifixion

**Crucifixion of Jesus under Pontius Pilate (prefect of Judea c. 26–36 CE) is multiply attested and coheres with Roman practice.**

[contested] hj-crucifixion-year

**Crucifixion year is commonly constrained to c. 30–33 CE by Pilate's tenure (26–36), Passover weekday arguments, and astronomical full-moon tables — exact year remains debated.**

[contested] hj-empty-tomb

**Empty-tomb narratives appear in the canonical Gospels with differences; whether an empty tomb is historical is debated; early creed in 1 Cor 15 emphasizes appearances more than tomb logistics.**

[well\_attested] hj-existence

**The existence of Jesus of Nazareth as a first-century Jewish man is the near-consensus position of critical historians of antiquity.**

[circumstantial] hj-family-rejection

**Traditions of family misunderstanding or tension (Mark 3; John 7) are often cited under the criterion of embarrassment as unlikely free invention by later church idealization.**

[well\_attested] hj-gal2-conflict

**Galatians 2 records a conflict between Paul and Cephas (Peter) at Antioch over table fellowship with gentiles — primary evidence of diversity and dispute in the earliest movement.**

[well\_attested] hj-galilee-context

**Early Roman Galilee included agricultural villages, fishing economy on the lake, and nearby urban centers such as Sepphoris and Tiberias.**

[contested] hj-herod-death

**The death of Herod the Great is conventionally dated to 4 BCE (with minority arguments for 1 BCE / other), anchoring the latest plausible nativity window in Matthew's framework.**

[well\_attested] hj-james-leadership

**James the brother of Jesus is attested as a Jerusalem leadership figure (Paul; Acts; Josephus Ant. 20.200) until his death c. 62 CE.**

[well\_attested] hj-john-baptist-movement

**John the Baptist is multiply attested (Josephus Ant. 18; Synoptics; Johannine tradition) as an independent purification/repentance preacher executed by Herod Antipas.**

[well\_attested] hj-kingdom-proclamation

**A core historical judgment across diverse scholars is that Jesus proclaimed God's kingdom / reign as central to his public activity.**

[contested] hj-language

**Jesus likely spoke Aramaic as a primary vernacular; Greek exposure in Galilee is plausible; Hebrew literacy/use is debated for the population stratum.**

[well\_attested] hj-literacy

**Literacy rates in Early Roman Judea/Galilee were limited relative to modern norms; most people encountered texts orally and through specialists.**

[literary\_theological] hj-magi-star

**Magi and star narratives in Matthew 2 are literary-theological traditions; astronomical "explanations" are speculative correlations, not historical proof.**

[interpretive] hj-miracles-method

**Miracle narratives are not historically "verified" under naturalistic historical method; historians can study reports, meanings, and social effects of wonder-traditions.**

[well\_attested] hj-parables

**Parables form a characteristic teaching form in the Synoptic tradition and are widely treated as a historically distinctive feature of Jesus' public speech.**

[contested] [hj-pauline-chronology](#)

**Pauline absolute chronology is reconstructed from Acts, the letters, and external anchors (Gallio inscription at Delphi); competing schemes (Ramsay, Knox, Hyldahl, et al.) differ by several years.**

[circumstantial] [hj-peter-rome](#)

**Peter's presence and martyrdom in Rome are early traditions (1 Clement; later Acts of Peter) with varying historical confidence; New Testament itself does not narrate a Roman martyrdom.**

[verified] [hj-pilate-stone](#)

**The Pilate Stone (Caesarea Maritima, 1961) independently attests Pontius Pilate as prefect of Judea.**

[contested] [hj-q-hypothesis](#)

**The Two-Source Hypothesis posits Markan priority plus a sayings source "Q" behind Matthew and Luke; Q remains a scholarly reconstruction without a surviving manuscript.**

[contested] [hj-quirinius](#)

**Luke's census notice linking Jesus' birth to a registration under Quirinius (6 CE) is a classic chronological problem relative to a Herodian birth before 4 BCE.**

[literary\_theological] [hj-resurrection-hist](#)

**Claims of bodily resurrection are theological assertions; historians can document early belief and proclamation, not laboratory verification of the event.**

[well\_attested] [hj-table-fellowship](#)

**Traditions of Jesus' open table fellowship with "sinners" and tax collectors are widely treated as historically plausible under embarrassment and multiple attestation.**

[well\_attested] [hj-temple-action](#)

**An action by Jesus in the Temple (disruption of commerce / symbolic demonstration) is multiply attested; interpretation ranges from prophetic sign to failed revolt cue.**

[contested] [hj-titles](#)

**Titles applied to Jesus (Messiah/Christ, Son of Man, Son of God, Lord) have layered historical and literary-theological histories; none should be treated as a single unproblematic first-century label without analysis.**

[well\_attested] [hj-women-movement](#)

**Early Christian sources name women as patrons, witnesses, and coworkers (e.g., Mary Magdalene traditions; Romans 16 co-workers); social roles are historically reconstructable within limits.**

[interpretive] [mod-criteria-critique](#)

**Classical criteria of authenticity (embarrassment, dissimilarity, multiple attestation) are historiographical tools with known biases; recent memory and social approaches revise their use.**

[interpretive] [mod-criteria-embarrassment](#)

**The criterion of embarrassment is a heuristic, not a proof algorithm; it can be misapplied when later communities reframe "embarrassing" material.**

[verified] [mod-critical-editions](#)

**NA28/UBS5 (and ongoing ECM/INTF work) are the standard working critical texts of the Greek NT for academic use.**

[verified] [mod-digital-dss](#)

**The Leon Levy Dead Sea Scrolls Digital Library enables open inspection of high-resolution plate images for many Qumran manuscripts.**

[well\_attested] [mod-genetics-limits](#)

**Ancient DNA of the Southern Levant informs regional demographic history; it cannot identify named New Testament individuals or prove specific genealogies in the Gospels.**

[interpretive] mod-historical-jesus-quests

**“Quests” for the historical Jesus are historiographical programs with shifting criteria; no single reconstruction commands universal assent.**

[interpretive] mod-memory-approach

**Social/collective memory approaches reconstruct how groups remembered Jesus rather than claiming verbatim ipsissima verba recovery.**

[well\_attested] mod-mythicisim-fringe

**Full mythicism (Jesus of Nazareth as entirely non-historical) remains a fringe position in mainstream historical scholarship of Second Temple Judaism and early Christianity.**

[verified] mod-na28-ubs5

**Nestle-Aland 28 and UBS5 are the standard working critical Greek NT editions for most academic exegesis; their apparatus documents selected variants, not every known reading.**

[well\_attested] mod-open-access-trend

**Open digital libraries (INTF NT.VMR, IAA DSS, British Library codices) have lowered barriers to primary manuscript inspection since the 2010s.**

[interpretive] mod-open-data-ethics

**Modern digital manuscript projects raise access, conservation, provenance, and citation-ethics issues distinct from the content of any single reading.**

[well\_attested] mod-population-genetics

**Population genetics of the Levant documents deep regional continuity with admixture layers; it does not identify individuals named in ancient texts.**

[verified] mod-print-gutenberg

**Print culture from Gutenberg onward multiplied biblical text access and stabilized vernacular canons — a reception-historical fact separate from first-century origins.**

[well\_attested] mod-radiocarbon-dss

**Radiocarbon dating of selected Dead Sea Scrolls supports late Second Temple copy ranges broadly consistent with paleography.**

[interpretive] mod-social-memory

**Social memory approaches treat Gospel traditions as communal remembering under social constraints rather than pure invention or pure stenography.**

[verified] mod-textus-receptus

**The Textus Receptus tradition (Erasmus onward) underlies early modern vernacular Bibles but is not the base text of modern critical editions (NA/UBS).**

[speculative] mod-turin-shroud

**The Shroud of Turin is a medieval relic by mainstream radiocarbon dating (1988); authenticity as first-century burial cloth remains speculative/unverified for historical Jesus studies.**

[verified] mod-war-70

**The Jewish-Roman War culminating in the 70 CE destruction of the Temple is a primary historical horizon for dating and interpreting the Synoptic Gospels.**

[well\_attested] nc-celsus

**Celsus (2nd c.), preserved mainly via Origen’s Contra Celsum, is an early pagan critic who treats Jesus as a historical magician/charlatan figure rather than a mythic non-entity.**



[well\_attested] nc-james

**Josephus, Antiquities 20.200 refers to “the brother of Jesus who is called Christ, James” in the account of Ananus’s execution of James — generally judged authentic.**

[well\_attested] nc-lucian

**Lucian of Samosata (2nd c.) satirizes Christians and refers to their crucified sophist in Passing of Peregrinus — evidence of known Christian devotion, not independent biography.**

[circumstantial] nc-mara

**The Syriac letter of Mara bar Serapion mentions a “wise king” executed by the Jews; identification with Jesus is possible but not certain.**

[well\_attested] nc-martial-juvenes

**No contemporary Roman historian from Jesus’ lifetime mentions him; the earliest non-Christian literary controls (Josephus, Tacitus, Pliny) are decades later.**

[verified] nc-pliny

**Pliny the Younger, Epistles 10.96–97, describes early second-century Christian worship practices in Bithynia-Pontus and imperial policy under Trajan.**

[circumstantial] nc-suetonius

**Suetonius, Claudius 25.4, refers to disturbances in Rome impulsore Chresto — often discussed as a possible garbled reference to Christ-related conflict, but identification is uncertain.**

[well\_attested] nc-tacitus

**Tacitus, Annals 15.44 reports that “Christus” was executed under Tiberius by the procurator Pontius Pilate and that the movement originated in Judea.**

[well\_attested] nc-tacitus-latin

**Tacitus Annals 15.44 (Latin) states that Christus suffered the extreme penalty under Tiberius by sentence of procurator Pontius Pilate, and that the superstio arose in Judea.**

[circumstantial] nc-talmud

**Certain Babylonian Talmud passages are sometimes read as hostile allusions to Jesus; dating, redaction, and identification are highly contested and often late.**

[contested] nc-tf

**Josephus, Antiquities 18.63–64 (Testimonium Flavianum) is widely judged partly authentic with Christian interpolations; fully authentic and fully forged positions are minorities.**

[contested] nc-tf-reconstructions

**Major scholarly reconstructions of the Testimonium Flavianum range from a short neutral core to more expansive partial authenticity; wholesale authenticity and wholesale forgery are minority poles.**

[circumstantial] nc-thallus-phlegon

**Later Christian authors cite Thallus and Phlegon regarding a darkness or eclipse around the time of the crucifixion; the original works are lost and the citations are mediated.**

[verified] nt-codex-alexandrinus

**Codex Alexandrinus (A 02, 5th c.) is a major early nearly complete Greek Bible witness held by the British Library.**

[well\_attested] nt-comma-johanneum

**The Comma Johanneum (1 John 5:7–8 Trinitarian expansion in some later Latin/Textus Receptus traditions) is absent from the earliest Greek manuscript tradition and is treated as secondary in modern critical editions.**

[verified] nt-ecm-method

**The Editio Critica Maior (ECM) and the Coherence-Based Genealogical Method (CBGM) model manuscript relationships as a guided stemmatic network rather than a simple bipartite Alexandrian/Byzantine tree.**

[well\_attested] nt-ending-mark

**The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major Greek witness editions as secondary, while shorter alternative endings also exist.**

[well\_attested] nt-eusebius-ch

**Eusebius's Church History is an indispensable but tendentious fourth-century source for earlier Christian literature and martyrdoms; source-critical caution is mandatory.**

[contested] nt-gospel-dates

**Critical consensus commonly dates Mark c. 65–75 CE, Matthew and Luke c. 80–90 CE, John c. 90–100 CE — with debate bands around each.**

[verified] nt-homoeoteleuton

**Many NT variants arise from ordinary scribal mechanics (homoeoteleuton, dittography, orthography), not theological conspiracy.**

[contested] nt-john-historicity

**John's Gospel is generally dated later than the Synoptics; its independent historical value for Jesus research is debated (high Christology vs. early tradition cores).**

[verified] nt-majuscules

**Fourth–fifth century majuscules (15 01 Sinaiticus, A 02 Alexandrinus, B 03 Vaticanus) are foundational for the critical text.**

[verified] nt-mark-ending

**The longer ending of Mark (16:9–20) is absent from the earliest major witnesses (15 NA28/UBS apparatuses).**

[verified] nt-ms-count

**Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.**

[well\_attested] nt-origen-hexapla

**Origen's Hexapla (3rd c.) arranged Hebrew and Greek columns for comparative Old Testament textual work — a landmark of ancient textual criticism.**

[verified] nt-p45-p46-p47

**Chester Beatty papyri (P45, P46, P47) are major third-century witnesses to Gospels/Acts, Paul, and Revelation respectively.**

[verified] nt-p46-paul

**Papyrus P46 is among the earliest substantial collections of Pauline letters (typically dated late 2nd / early 3rd century CE).**

[well\_attested] nt-p52

**Papyrus P52 (Rylands Greek P 457) is among the earliest surviving NT fragments (John 18), paleographically dated roughly to the second century CE.**

[verified] nt-p66-p75

**Bodmer papyri P66 (John) and P75 (Luke/John) are major early substantial witnesses typically dated to the late 2nd / early 3rd century and foundational for early Alexandrian text studies.**

[well\_attested] nt-paul-dates

**Undisputed Pauline letters are typically dated c. 49–58 CE and are the earliest surviving Christian literary corpus.**

[well\_attested] nt-pericope-adulterae

**The pericope adulterae (John 7:53–8:11) is widely judged a later insertion on strong external manuscript grounds, though the story circulated early in the Latin and some Greek traditions.**

[contested] nt-synoptic-problem

**The Synoptic Problem (literary relationship of Matthew, Mark, Luke) remains an active field; Markan priority is majority, Q hypothesis is majority but contested by Farrer and other models.**

[verified] nt-textual-criticism

**Greek New Testament continuous-text manuscripts number on the order of several thousand, with additional lectionaries and versions.**

[verified] nt-variants

**Hundreds of thousands of variant readings exist across the tradition; the vast majority are orthographic or trivial, while a minority affect meaning.**

[well\_attested] nt-western-text

**The so-called Western text (e.g., Codex Bezae in Acts) often presents freer, paraphrastic readings that complicate simple Alexandrian/Byzantine dichotomies.**

[verified] st-coinage-revolt

**Jewish revolt coinage (First Revolt 66–70 CE; Bar Kokhba 132–135 CE) provides dated material propaganda and economic evidence independent of Christian texts.**

[verified] st-community-rule

**Qumran sectarian texts (e.g., Community Rule 1QS, War Scroll 1QM, Pesharim) document a Jewish movement with distinctive purity, calendar, and eschatology in the late Second Temple period.**

[verified] st-dss

**Dead Sea Scrolls (discovered 1946–1956) preserve Hebrew Bible books and sectarian texts from roughly the third century BCE to first century CE.**

[well\_attested] st-dss-books

**Among biblical DSS copies, Psalms, Deuteronomy, Isaiah, Exodus, and Genesis are among the most frequently attested books; Esther is not securely attested at Qumran.**

[verified] st-herod-temple

**Herod's expansion of the Jerusalem Temple Mount is archaeologically and literarily documented (Josephus; Western Wall / Temple Mount retaining architecture).**

[well\_attested] st-isaiah-stability

**Comparison of 1QIsaC (c. 2nd–1st century BCE) with the medieval Masoretic Text shows mostly orthographic and minor variants.**

[verified] st-josephus-corpus

**Flavius Josephus (late first century CE) is a principal non-Christian Jewish historian for Herodian and early Roman Judea.**

[verified] st-lxx-textual

**The Septuagint often preserves readings that differ from the medieval Masoretic Text; some align with Qumran Hebrew witnesses.**

[verified] st-mikvaot

**Stepped ritual baths (miqva'ot) are archaeologically widespread in late Second Temple Judea and Galilee, evidencing purity practice infrastructure.**

[well\_attested] st-mishnah-context

**The Mishnah (c. 200 CE redaction) and related Tannaitic literature preserve legal memory of Second Temple practice but are post-70 literary products requiring critical use for pre-70 reconstruction.**

[well\_attested] st-parties

**Josephus and later rabbinic memory describe Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes as major Jewish schools; exact social demographics remain reconstructed.**

[well\_attested] st-pharisees-josephus

**Josephus's descriptions of Pharisees, Sadducees, and Essenes are primary but tendentious; social realities were more complex than three-school schemes.**

[verified] st-philo

**Philo of Alexandria provides contemporary diaspora Jewish philosophical and exegetical context for the early first century CE.**

[verified] st-prefecture

**Roman Judea after 6 CE was administered by equestrian prefects (later procurators) based primarily at Caesarea, with troops and judicial powers including capital cases in practice.**

[contested] st-synagogue-origins

**The institutional origins and pre-70 function of "synagogues" remain debated; archaeological assembly buildings and literary references do not form a single simple type.**

[well\_attested] st-temple-economy

**The Jerusalem Temple system involved tithes, offerings, and currency exchange for worshippers — a documented economic-religious complex in Josephus and later rabbinic memory.**